PROJECT DESCRIPTION / BASIC DRAWING Age: Freshman and Sophmore
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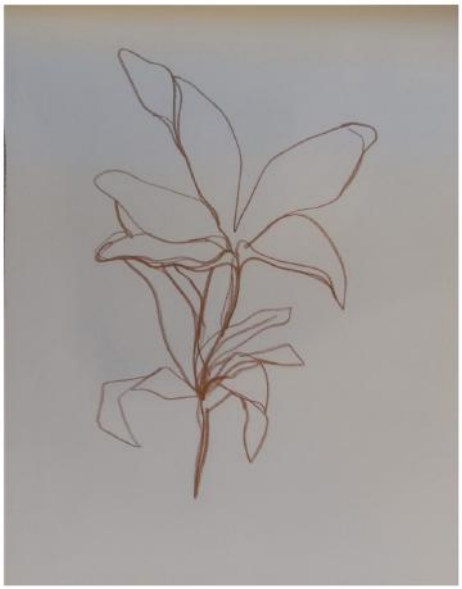
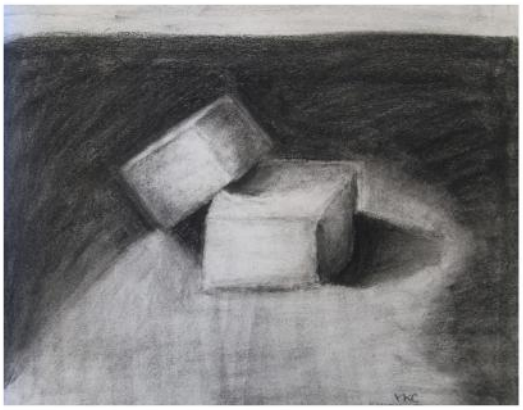
Goals: Provide an experience that leads to a more complex understanding of the ephemeral qualities of drawing. Our mind makes a maps of the world and we use it to navigate it day to day. It is a shorthand of "general" notions of objects. A flower has a general "flowerness." A face or dog etc. Drawing from life challenges this way of seeing, and provokes "deep observation." This is not merely in service to making an acurate represenation, but rather is actually a form of observed true knowledge of the world and its inhabitants. Good drawing is not only accuracy, but rather understanding something about the object seen and the person doing the seeing.



Contour Drawing: A contour line defines volume. The tiger lily was chosen for its sinuous lines and overlapping elements. Our studies were done with set limits on time and technique; through which the students experienced time as an integral component of drawing.



Shadow / Shade: Working with semi-transparent foam blocks, we focused on the effects of light on transparent material as well as the reflected light in shadows. This focuses the eye to see what is there rather than relying on what the mind thinks is there.

Abstraction / Material Study: Through guided directions from the instructor, students respond spontaneously with their drawing materials. Patterns, symbols, and gestures are allowed to interact, and materials are combined in unorthodox ways to generate the improvised and accidental.

Apple Still Life / Tone / Composition: The first part of this assignment is to create the sensation of a red apple next to a green apple through only a tonal relationship. Afterwards, we utilized a view finder to move between close up and distanced compositions. Both of these assignments highlight the inner structure and relationships of a picture.

Still Life with Material Study: Building on the four previous lessons, the students create a still life that merges materials (abstraction) with tools (contour, shade, composition) to create unexpected affects.

Large Drawings: Drawings are conventionally small, but the medium extends itself easily to a large scale. A grid technique is employed by the students to experience scale as an integral component of a work's expression.

Students working on large drawings

Portraits / Figure: Students gain a heightened awareness of the subtlety of facial features, while exploring their own unique style and approach. The drawings serve as documents of the class and reinforce the collective nature of making art.

Figure Drawing: The figure in repose is a challenging subject to make interesting. Students were asked to find unique perscetival angles to work from.

Still Life Drawing: Using contour line and shading, students captured the essence of the materials in the still life and were required to sketch in a contextual background.